

Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + carboplatin

Lung · NCCP 00568 · version 5

Treatment summary

- Cycles 1-4: all 3 medicines every 21 days.
- Maintenance: pembrolizumab + pemetrexed every 21 days if appropriate.
- Key support: folic acid, vitamin B12 and anti-sickness treatment.

How to use this passport

- Bring it to day ward, clinic, GP or ED if you become unwell.
- Write the worst grade for each symptom group in each cycle.
- If unsure of the grade, describe the symptom instead - your team can classify it.

The same side-effect groups used in your anatomy guide

Symptom group	Main medicine link	What to notice
Hormones / brain	Pembrolizumab	Unusual tiredness, dizziness, headache, thirst or passing more urine.
Lungs / breathlessness	Pembrolizumab	New cough or shortness of breath.
Heart	Pembrolizumab	Chest pain, racing heartbeat, fainting.
Liver	Pembrolizumab	Yellow eyes/skin, dark urine or liver blood-test changes.
Kidneys	Pemetrexed / pembrolizumab	Less urine, swelling or kidney blood-test changes.
Bowel	Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy	New diarrhoea, persistent vomiting or severe tummy pain.
Skin / nerves	Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy	Spreading rash, blisters, weakness or new numbness.
Blood / infection	Pemetrexed / carboplatin	Fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell.

Important

Immune-related symptoms can begin during treatment or after treatment has stopped. New or rapidly worsening symptoms should be reported even if they are not on this page.

Induction cycles - symptom grading

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Write a grade from 0-4 for the worst symptom in each group during that cycle. Grade 0 = none. If you are unsure, write a short description instead.

Symptom group	C1	C2	C3	C4
Hormones / brain				
Lungs / breathlessness				
Heart				
Liver				
Kidneys				
Bowel				
Skin / nerves				
Blood / infection				

Cycle dates

C1: C2: C3: C4:

Actions / calls / dose changes

Maintenance cycles - symptom grading

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Continue the same symptom groups after carboplatin stops. The side-effect language stays the same so changes are easier to recognise across treatment phases.

Maintenance M1-M4

Symptom group	M1	M2	M3	M4
Hormones / brain				
Lungs / breathlessness				
Heart				
Liver				
Kidneys				
Bowel				
Skin / nerves				
Blood / infection				

Maintenance M5-M8

Symptom group	M5	M6	M7	M8
Hormones / brain				
Lungs / breathlessness				
Heart				
Liver				
Kidneys				
Bowel				
Skin / nerves				
Blood / infection				

M9+ / continuation notes

Simple symptom grading example

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Example: shortness of breath / dyspnoea

This example uses simplified patient-facing wording based on CTCAE dyspnoea descriptors. It supports communication; it does not replace clinical assessment.

Grade	What it means for shortness of breath
0	No shortness of breath.
1	Shortness of breath with moderate exertion.
2	Shortness of breath with minimal exertion; it limits instrumental daily activities such as shopping or preparing meals.
3	Shortness of breath at rest; it limits self-care activities. Urgent same-day assessment is needed.
4	Life-threatening breathing problem; urgent intervention is required. Call 112/999 for severe breathing difficulty.

Urgent oncology contacts

Mon-Fri 8am-5pm
Acute Oncology Service

087 181 9645

Sat / Sun / Bank Holiday 9am-5pm
CUH switch - ask for medical oncology

021 4922000

Day unit treatment queries
Dunmanway Day Unit

021 4922324

Evenings / overnight

Contact GP out-of-hours or your nearest emergency department. In an emergency call 112 or 999.

Patient portal

<https://sactcheck.com/patient/00568/>



Notes